Pre-Class Assignment: Weyerhaeuser WSJ Article

"America's Largest Landowner Is Using AI to Digitize the Forest"

ECON 470 — Microeconomics of Artificial Intelligence

Spring 2026

Reading: Ryan Dezember, "America's Largest Landowner Is Using AI to Digitize the Forest," *The Wall Street Journal*, April 23, 2026.

Instructions: Answer each question in 1–2 sentences. These are reading-check questions — they should be quick if you read the article. You must submit this assignment in person. The assignment must be handwritten. No photocopies will be accepted.

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1. Roughly how large is Weyerhaeuser's timberland in the U.S. and Canada, and how long has the company been growing forests?
2. By how much does Weyerhaeuser hope to boost annual profits by the end of the decade, and is this increase supposed to depend on lumber prices rising?
3. Name two AI applications the article describes that are **similar** to what other manufacturing firms do (not specific to forestry).
4. What is the "digital twin" of Weyerhaeuser's timberlands, and what three kinds of sensing technology are used to build it?
5. How did Weyerhaeuser previously estimate seedling survival rates, and how does AI change that process?
6. What does the in-cabin AI assistant built with Nordic Forestry Automation show the operator, and what decision does it help with?
7. In the driverless-skidder pilot, where was the operator located relative to the logging site, and what firm supplied the navigation technology?